



ON THE WRITE LINE

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NO NEED TO PRESS THE EMERGENCY BUTTON AS YET

However, there's plenty of honest **introspection** needed and a lot more thought put into execution for the Indian team to be back to winning ways again.

In what appeared to be a one-sided final, Spain beat defending champions Argentina to win the FIFA World Cup after a wait of 16 years. They were in possession of the ball far more than the Argentinians, who seemed a little listless. They also had more shots at goal than the champions. But for the classy defending of the Argentinian goalie, the scoreline would have been far more than the 1-0 that the game ended with.

The final whistle also saw some unsavoury scenes, with a fight breaking out between some Spanish reserve players and the Argentinian players. The Argentinians had played a pretty rough game as they tried to stop the storming Spanish attackers. That seemed to have spilt over after the final whistle.

The game once again showed why the Spanish League remains the best and most competitive league, though the English Premier League, backed by its media, gets more coverage by virtue of the English language being more widely used in most of the world.

England and last-time's runners-up France did very well till they were beaten. Spain produced moments of magic, while Lionel

Messi inspired Argentina into the final. While Argentina were left to rue the missed opportunities, the Indian cricket team also did not grab the chances they had of winning the one-day series with some poor fielding efforts.

People have been speaking about the Indian batters hammering the bowling on flat pitches and smaller boundaries in the IPL and then getting exposed in unfamiliar conditions in England. The fact is that there were flat pitches in India, alright, but it's the ridiculously small boundaries that flatter the batter, whose mishits can clear the ropes, while in countries with bigger and longer boundaries these same hits are caught inside the boundary line.

It's absolutely imperative, when the new Indian season begins, to get the boundary sizes increased so that our batters get used to that before the World Cup next year. At virtually every ground, there is plenty of space for people to walk behind the LED advertising boards, so it tells you that if this space is utilised, the boundary size will automatically increase. This will also give our spin bowlers the opportunity to bowl a bit slower so that they can get the loop and turn that a slower delivery produces. The medium-pace darters they